

IN PRODUCTION | A MAJOR US BROADCAST NEWSROOM

One of the country's biggest newsrooms is rebuilding its core editorial workflow on Airtable.

Not a side project or a team experiment. A flagship, newsroom-wide editorial production platform: story intake, planning, assignments, production tracking, and the cross-functional governance around it, built on Airtable with a dedicated Airtable Professional Services team embedded alongside the newsroom's own product and engineering org. It is live in build now, moving from build through user testing toward launch. Below is an honest look at how it is actually being built, for your team to react to.

Build phase: Build to UAT to launch

Footprint: Hundreds of internal users

Model: Airtable Professional Services + newsroom product/engineering

AI: Governed activation in flight

01 What the newsroom built on Airtable

STORY LIFECYCLE, END TO END

One connected system carries a story from pitch and intake through planning, assignment, field and edit production, and archive. The same records flow across desks and shows instead of being copied between docs and spreadsheets.

CROSS-FUNCTIONAL GOVERNANCE

A weekly sponsor check-in with newsroom editorial leadership and a broader stakeholder session keep the build aligned to how the newsroom actually works, not a vendor's ideal of it.

NEWSROOM-SCALE DATA, NOT APP-SCALE

The platform runs at hundreds of thousands of rows across a working newsroom. Airtable product engineering is engaged on the row and rate architecture so volume is a design input, not a wall.

AI AS A GOVERNED WORKSTREAM

AI features are being switched on deliberately, with the newsroom's legal and compliance org reviewing terms and a bring-your-own-key path. An interim integration approach is in flight so the newsroom is not blocked waiting.

02 How it is being built (the part your devs will care about)

A dedicated Airtable Professional Services team (a deployment lead plus product engineering) works side by side with the newsroom's own product manager and engineering org. The deployment lead owns scope, delivery, and risk; product engineering owns performance, architecture, and the AI governance configuration. The newsroom owns the editorial model and the workflow it has to support.

THE ARCHITECTURE CHOICE

Airtable is the **workflow and coordination layer** that sits around the systems of record (the newsroom control room, archive, and content systems). It is not trying to replace the rundown or the media asset store. It connects them and makes the work in between visible.

THE HONEST PART

Newsroom volume is real. Hundreds of thousands of rows across an active operation. The team is working row and rate limits with Airtable product engineering as a live constraint, with an interim integration path in place while the long-term scale design matures.

1

Flagship newsroom-wide editorial platform, not a team pilot

2

Dedicated Airtable teams embedded: deployment plus product engineering

~440

Internal users on Airtable across the newsroom footprint

UAT

Currently in user testing, moving toward a near-term go-live

WHY THIS MAPS TO WHAT YOU ARE BUILDING AT 60 MINUTES

A show-level operation standing up new production infrastructure needs a workflow layer that flexes to how the team actually works, scales with the volume a working newsroom generates, and lets editorial and tech govern AI on their own terms. That is exactly what this deployment is proving out in production right now. There is a credible, in-flight blueprint your devs can pressure-test against, not a slide deck.

Want a working session on what this looks like for 60 Minutes?

Bring your tech lead. We can walk the architecture honestly, not the demo.

Meghan